SURVIVAL-TIPS

Materials & Construction

Building materials and processes including clay, brick, lime, mortar, concrete, glass, and polymers.

Stage 06 • Generated 2026-10-30 • 3 knowledge entries

How to use this handbook

Use this guide as a learning aid, not as a substitute for official emergency instructions or expert assessment. Every AI-extracted tip must be reviewed before it is treated as verified guidance. Never infer that a wild plant, mushroom, water source, or improvised material is safe based on appearance alone.

1. Use Local, Sustainable Materials

Plan emergency shelter solutions around locally available materials that can be sourced sustainably.

Action type: planning_guidance

Steps

1. Identify locally available materials and construction methods.
2. Assess whether sourcing can be sustained without damaging local resources.
3. Use suitable locally available materials in the shelter design.

Warnings

• The UNHCR entry is marked outdated and under revision; check current national and technical guidance before applying it.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

2. Employ Plastic Sheeting as Primary Shelter Component

Plastic sheeting can be an important emergency-shelter component, often combined with rigid materials; it needs suitable support and has limitations in severe weather.

Action type: material_guidance

Steps

1. Consider plastic sheeting as one component of a shelter, potentially combined with rigid materials.
2. Provide an appropriate supporting frame or structure.
3. Assess local wind and rain exposure before relying on plastic sheeting as the main weather barrier.

Warnings

• Plastic sheeting alone does not provide strong resistance to high winds or heavy rain.

• Consider environmental impacts and responsible disposal.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

3. Insulate and Seal Shelters in Cold Climates

In cold climates, UNHCR recommends covering windows and doors with translucent plastic sheeting and designing walls, ceilings, and floors to insulate against cold air.

Action type: cold_climate_shelter_guidance

Steps

1. Cover windows and doors with translucent plastic sheeting as described in the source.
2. Design walls, ceilings, and floors to provide insulation from cold air.

Warnings

• The cited entry is marked outdated and under revision. Consider ventilation and safe heating when improving insulation.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards